

LEO

the Light-Up Firefly



A StorySprout Press Book





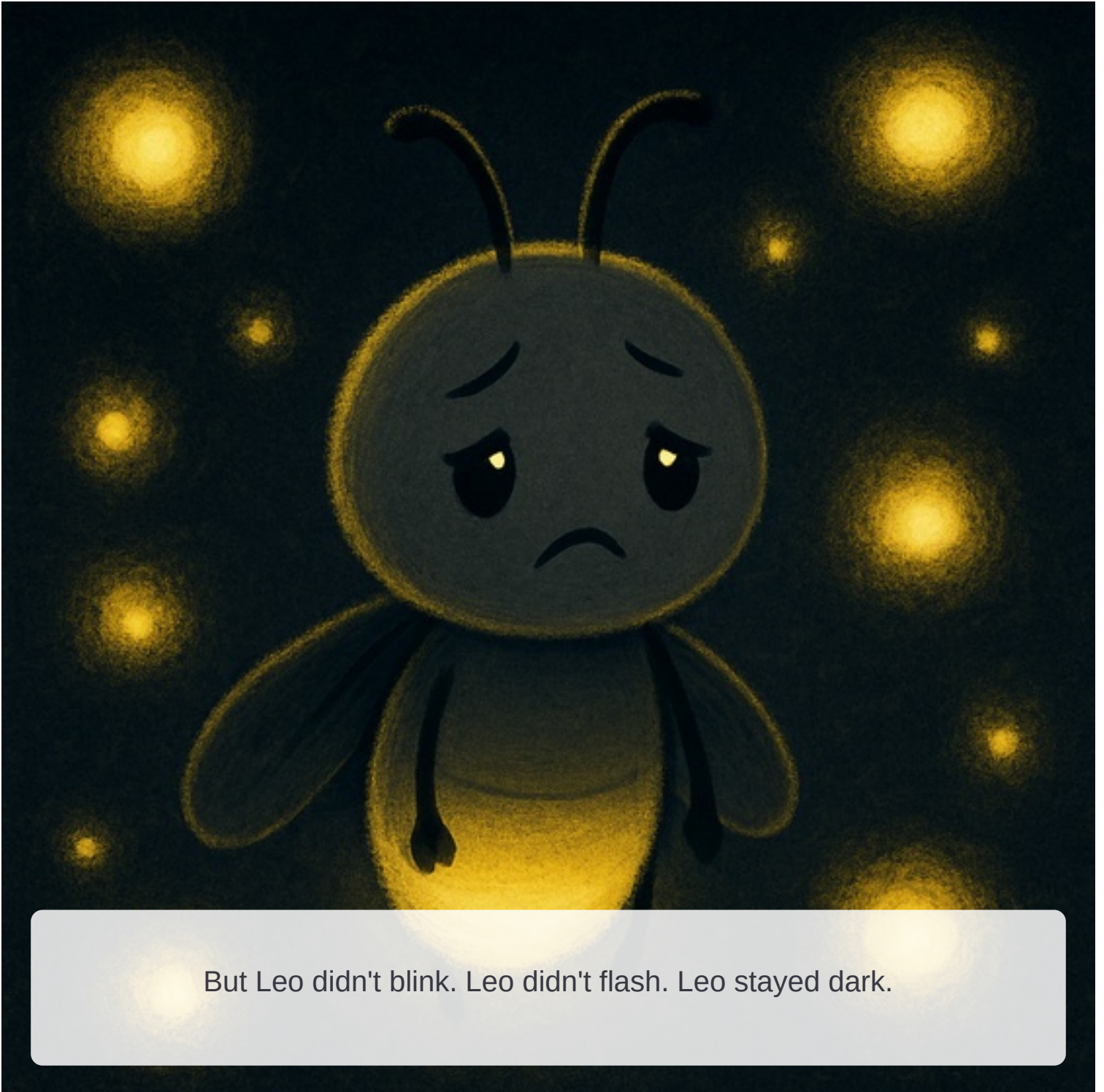
When the sun went down over the Whisper Meadow, the magic began.



Blink! Flash! Glow! All the fireflies started their nighttime dance.



Leo tried as hard as he could. He squeezed his eyes shut. He held his breath.



But Leo didn't blink. Leo didn't flash. Leo stayed dark.



"What's wrong, Leo?" asked Luna, zipping down beside him. Her light was as bright as a diamond.



"I'm broken, Luna," Leo whispered. "I don't have a light like everyone else."



Bella the Beetle waved an antenna. "Everyone has something special, Leo. Maybe your light is just shy."



"Let's ask Grandfather Glow," Luna suggested. They flew toward the Great Mushroom.



Grandfather Glow sat on top of the tallest mushroom. He listened to Leo's story.



"A light that flashes is for finding friends," the old firefly said. "But there are many kinds of light in this world."



Leo still felt sad. As they flew home, they heard a tiny, shivering sound.



It was Barnaby the Baby Bunny. He was lost in the thorns and very scared.



"We'll help you!" cried the other fireflies. They flew into the bushes, flashing their bright lights.



Flash! Flash! Flash! But the light was too fast. It made the shadows jump, and Barnaby hid his eyes.



"Stop!" Leo cried. "You're scaring him!" Leo landed right in front of the bunny.



Leo didn't try to flash. Instead, he thought about a warm, cozy campfire. He started to hum a soft tune.



Slowly, Leo's tail began to shine. It wasn't a flash. It was a steady, warm, golden glow.



It was like a tiny nightlight. Barnaby the Bunny stopped shivering. He looked at Leo and felt safe.



"Follow me," Leo said gently. He stayed close to the ground, lighting the way through the grass.



Bella the Beetle helped move the leaves. "Go this way, Barnaby!" she called.



Soon, they found the bunny's burrow. His mother was waiting for him.



The other fireflies watched from above. "Leo's light stayed on!" Luna cheered. "He has a lantern-light!"



Leo felt a warm glow in his heart. He wasn't broken at all. He had a special light that could save the day.



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